

Part 6: Skills And Abilities, Equipment And Equipment Slots

6.1 Skills and Abilities

A *Zona Alfa* crew is a hot mess of the desperate and the disparate; a collection of fugitives, loners, thrill-seekers, and misfits who are crazy enough to risk the Exclusion Zone, and skilled enough to stay there. This *eclectic* band of unique individuals will form your crew and, through your leadership, achieve fortune or death.

Now the easiest way to portray the distinct skill sets of these individuals is to vary the model's Combat Experience and starting Equipment. For example, a Green recruit in the military's Zone Enforcement Unit would certainly have military-grade equipment but probably a low Will and Combat Ability. On the other hand, a street-hardened thug signing on to a bandit crew, or hired to protect a private Salvage run, would have decent Combat Ability and Will, but lesser quality weapons and armor.

Zona Alfa uses another variable to distinguish between tactical styles and combat proficiency: Skills. While Combat Experience reflects various degrees of training and proficiency by granting an increased number of Actions per turn to more veteran characters, Skills allow players to create unique characters with other, distinct abilities.

Remember Green recruits do not begin with any particular Skills. Hardened crew members have one, while Veterans can select two. Of course, your crew members can advance and gain experience, increasing their Combat Experience over successive games, so long as they stay alive. No character may have more than two Skills.

Skills List

- **Bone Doc:** Probably attended Med-School for a semester or had some combat medic training in the military, a Bone Doc can double up on Med-Kits when assigning them in his Equipment Slots, meaning that two can be carried per slot. When a Bone Doc applies a Med-Kit to himself or Allied unit, the Wound is replaced with one Pinned Counter rather than two.
- **Fuse Cutter:** The explosives expert, the Fuse Cutter can carry up to three Hand Grenades, Molotov Cocktails, or Satchel Charges, instead of the standard two. The Fuse Cutter also receives a +2 to all Explosives-related Skill Checks like de-fusing an IED or booby-trapped door.
 - **Hard:** Walking that fine line between bravery and stupidity, this character ignores their first Pinned result and always receives a +1 bonus to their Will Stat when rolling for Deflected Hits.
 - **Hustle:** Quick on their feet, whenever this model spends two consecutive Actions to Move, they receive an extra 2" to the total. So a Hardened trooper can move 14" with two back-to-back Move Actions rather than the standard 12".
 - **Knife Man:** Knife men function best up close and personal. They receive a +1 to all Melee Combat rolls and, if appropriately armed, may fire/use two Melee weapons in close combat for one Action.

When you're in the Zone, always assume someone or something is trying to kill you- even if you can't see it. Most of the time, you won't be wrong.
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- **Leader:** There's one in every crowd and only room for one in a Crew. Leaders grant a +1 bonus to all Will/Rally rolls for allied units in Line of Sight to the Leader figure. Leaders also have a special 'Order' Action that allows them to 'transfer' or give their own Actions to other members of their squad. The recipient must be within 12" and in Line of Sight of the Leader figure, and must immediately perform the Ordered Action. Any effects of this transferred Action/s must be taken and resolved before the Leader can perform any more Actions.
- **Scrounger:** Some guys have a knack for finding stuff. Scroungers can Search a Hot Spot twice instead of just once. Each Search is a separate Action, but they double your chance at finding something useful. *I entered the Chernya Woods four days ago, trying to find a short cut to the west edge of the Red Zone. Big mistake. Compass went all wonky in here and the place is a damn maze.*
- **Steady Hands:** Maybe their grandfather took them hunting, perhaps they received some special Military training, either way, these shooters get a +1 to all Ranged Attack rolls. This Ability stacks with the Aim bonus modifiers and any appropriate Gear. © Lead Adventure Miniatures
- **Unload:** When this model spends two consecutive Actions on a Ranged Attack with an appropriate ranged combat weapon, such as an Assault Rifle, against a single target, it adds two bonus dice to the combined Firepower roll. Unload represents the model emptying the weapons' magazine in one go. After using the **Unload** ability, the model must spend 1 Action to 'reload' the weapon before it can be fired again.
For example, a two Action Ranged Attack with an Assault Rifle against the same target would roll 8 Firepower dice rather than the usual 6. A similar attack with a pistol – say in Melee – would roll 4 Firepower dice instead of 2. A model armed with a Flamethrower, RPG, Grenade Launcher, or Sniper rifle would not be able to use the Unload ability.
- **Wrench:** This is the one who's always tinkering with the GAZ engine, modding the gas tube on his AK-74, or jury-rigging the camp stove. Handy with anything mechanical, a Wrench gets a +2 to all Mechanical-Related Skill checks.